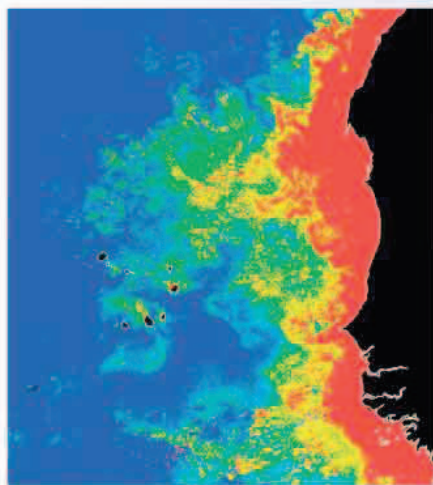




RICH SEAS

Deep water drawn up from the seabed by upwelling contains dissolved nutrients that act as fertilizer for the plantlike algae of the phytoplankton. This causes vigorous growth, which feeds swarms of tiny animals. These support huge schools of small fish such as anchovy, which attract bigger fish, sharks, dolphins, and other oceanic predators.

▲ **ON THE PROWL**
The rich pickings in an upwelling zone attract hundreds of big, hungry hunters, including these hammerhead sharks.



▲ **PLANKTON GROWTH**
This satellite image of an upwelling zone off the west coast of Africa shows regions of dense plankton growth in red and yellow.

Upwelling zones

In some parts of the world, the prevailing wind drives the surface water of the ocean away from the shore. This forces deeper water to well up from below to take its place. The water contains chemicals and minerals that fuel the growth of plankton, providing food for fish. Similar upwelling effects create food-rich zones over submerged seamounts and near the equator. But there are also regions where surface water is forced to sink, and this has the opposite result.